

## Patient Chart - Prior Authorization Request

### Patient Information

Name: Jane Doe (synthetic)

Date of Birth: 1965-03-14

MRN: SYNTH-00042

Insurance ID: SYNTH-INS-7731

Ordering Physician: Dr. A. Smith, MD (treating physician)

### Primary Diagnosis

Lumbar spinal stenosis with neurogenic claudication

ICD-10: M48.06 (Spinal stenosis, lumbar region)

### Treatment Requested

MRI of the lumbar spine without contrast (CPT 72148)

Requested facility: Regional Imaging Center

Urgency: Routine (within 30 days)

### Clinical History

Patient has a 7-month history of progressive low back pain radiating to both lower extremities, consistent with neurogenic claudication. Symptoms began in October 2025 following a minor lifting injury at work.

Conservative treatment completed over the past 6 months includes:

- Physical therapy (18 sessions, Nov 2025 to Jan 2026): marginal improvement
- NSAIDs (ibuprofen 600 mg TID x 8 weeks): partial pain relief, discontinued due to GI intolerance
- Epidural steroid injection (Feb 2026): temporary relief lasting 4 weeks

Symptoms have worsened over the past 6 weeks. Patient now reports significant limitation in walking distance (less than one block) and difficulty with ADLs.

### Supporting Evidence

- Plain X-ray lumbar spine (Nov 2025): degenerative disc disease L4-L5, L5-S1; no acute fracture
- EMG/nerve conduction study (Jan 2026): bilateral L4-L5 radiculopathy
- VAS pain score: 7/10 at rest, 9/10 with activity
- Oswestry Disability Index: 52% (severe disability)
- No prior MRI of lumbar spine on record
- No red-flag symptoms (no bowel/bladder dysfunction, no fever, no weight loss)

### Physician Attestation

I, Dr. A. Smith, MD, attest that this patient has failed conservative therapy and that advanced imaging is medically necessary to guide further treatment planning, including possible surgical evaluation.

Signature: [Dr. A. Smith, MD]    Date: 2026-05-29